

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT (PRD)

Project Name

CODA Business OS

Tagline:

"Build your business. Build your trust. Unlock your growth."

1. Executive Summary

CODA Business OS is a mobile-first, low-bandwidth business operating platform designed specifically for African micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs).

The platform combines:

- Business storefronts
- Marketplace functionality
- Inventory management
- Revenue and expense tracking
- Banking integration
- AI-assisted bookkeeping
- Credit scoring
- Progressive business financing

Unlike traditional ERP, accounting, or marketplace platforms, CODA's primary objective is to help businesses establish a verifiable financial identity that enables access to formal financial services and business credit.

The platform is designed for:

- Small businesses
- Informal traders
- Side hustlers
- Retail shops
- Service providers
- Freelancers
- Market vendors
- Online sellers

The product philosophy is:

Users do not want accounting software.

Users want more sales, easier money management, and access to capital.

2. Vision Statement

To become Africa's largest financial operating system for small businesses by transforming business activity into financial trust.

3. Mission Statement

Help every African small business build a digital financial identity that unlocks growth opportunities.

4. Problem Statement

Millions of African businesses operate informally.

Common problems include:

- No bookkeeping
- No financial history
- No business credit score
- No access to loans
- No audited statements
- No inventory tracking
- No structured revenue records
- No collateral

Banks struggle to lend because they cannot reliably assess risk.

Small businesses struggle to grow because they cannot access financing.

CODA solves both problems.

5. Core Value Proposition

For Businesses

- Create a professional business presence
- Sell online immediately

- Track sales automatically
- Generate invoices and receipts
- Build business credibility
- Access financing

For Banks

- Access verified SME financial data
 - Reduce lending risk
 - Improve loan repayment performance
 - Create new lending opportunities
-

6. Target Users

Primary Users

Micro Businesses

Examples:

- Food vendors
 - Market traders
 - Hair salons
 - Barbers
 - Tailors
 - Mechanics
 - Small retailers
-

Small Businesses

Examples:

- Restaurants
 - Pharmacies
 - Fashion stores
 - Electronics stores
 - Wholesalers
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Service Businesses

Examples:

- Freelancers
 - Consultants
 - Agencies
 - Repair services
 - Cleaning companies
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7. Product Pillars

The product consists of five major pillars:

Pillar 1

Business Marketplace

Pillar 2

Business Operating System

Pillar 3

AI Bookkeeping Assistant

Pillar 4

Business Credit Engine

Pillar 5

Embedded Finance Platform

8. User Journey

Stage 1

User discovers CODA.

Promise:

Start selling today.

Stage 2

User creates account.

Requirements:

- Phone number
- Password
- OTP verification

No BVN required.

Stage 3

User creates business.

Inputs:

- Business name
- Business category
- State
- City
- Description

Output:

Business storefront.

Example:

business.coda.ng

Stage 4

User uploads products/services.

Inputs:

- Product name
- Price

- Images
 - Stock
 - Description
-

Stage 5

User begins selling.

Features:

- Sales recording
 - Invoice generation
 - Receipt generation
 - WhatsApp sharing
-

Stage 6

System begins building financial identity.

Metrics tracked:

- Revenue
 - Expenses
 - Inventory
 - Cash flow
 - Repayment behavior
 - Customer activity
-

Stage 7

Business trust score generated.

Stage 8

Business becomes eligible for financing.

9. Verification Framework

Level 0

Anonymous

Allowed:

- Browse
- Create business
- Upload products

Restricted:

- Banking
 - Lending
-

Level 1

Phone verified.

Unlocks:

- Sales
 - Inventory
 - Marketplace
-

Level 2

Identity verified.

Requirements:

- BVN
- NIN
- Selfie verification

Unlocks:

- Payments
 - Banking
 - Credit score
-

Level 3

Business verified.

Requirements:

- CAC registration
- Tax information

Unlocks:

- Loans
 - Higher limits
 - Advanced analytics
-

10. Marketplace Module

Features:

- Business profile
- Storefront
- Product catalog
- Service catalog
- Categories
- Search
- Ratings
- Reviews
- Promotions
- Discounts
- QR codes
- Shareable links

Example:

shop.coda.ng/business-name

11. Sales Module

Features:

- Record sale
- Record payment
- Refunds

- Partial payments
- Sales history
- Customer history

Outputs:

- Revenue reports
 - Profit estimates
 - Cash flow analysis
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12. Inventory Module

Features:

- Add stock
- Reduce stock
- Reorder alerts
- Supplier management
- Stock movement history
- Inventory valuation

Goal:

Automatic inventory management with minimal user interaction.

13. Invoice Module

Users can:

- Create invoices
 - Generate quotations
 - Generate purchase orders
 - Generate receipts
 - Download PDF
 - Share via WhatsApp
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14. Receipt Scanning Module

User uploads:

- Receipt image

- Invoice image
- Purchase order image

AI extracts:

- Vendor
- Amount
- Date
- Tax
- Category
- Payment method

No manual bookkeeping required.

15. Banking Module

Partner banks expose:

- Account balances
- Transactions
- Transfers
- Overdrafts
- Loan repayments

Users can:

- View cash flow
 - Monitor balances
 - Monitor business spending
 - Monitor revenue
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16. AI Financial Assistant

Examples:

Prompt:

"How much did I make this month?"

Output:

- Revenue
- Expenses

- Profit
-

Prompt:

"Can I afford to buy this?"

Output:

- Recommendation
 - Risk score
-

Prompt:

"Why am I losing money?"

Output:

- Expense analysis
 - Revenue trends
-

Prompt:

"How much loan can I get?"

Output:

- Estimated eligibility
 - Confidence score
-

17. Business Trust Score

Every business receives:

CODA Trust Score

Range:

0-1000

Inputs

Revenue Stability

25%

Expense Tracking

20%

Repayment History

20%

Inventory Movement

15%

Account Activity

10%

Business Age

10%

18. Progressive Lending Model

New businesses start with:

Loan Tier 1

- ₦10,000–₦20,000
 - 7 days
-

Loan Tier 2

- ₦50,000
 - 14 days
-

Loan Tier 3

- ₦100,000
 - 30 days
-

Loan Tier 4

- ₦250,000
 - 60 days
-

Loan Tier 5

- ₦500,000+
-

19. Reward Engine

Users earn trust points.

Examples:

Action	Reward
Record sale	+5
Upload receipt	+10
Invoice creation	+5
Monthly reconciliation	+50
Loan repayment	+100

Benefits:

- Higher scores
 - Lower loan rates
 - Premium access
 - Cashback rewards
-

20. WhatsApp Platform

Users can interact via WhatsApp.

Examples:

"Sold rice 45000"

Result:

Sale recorded.

"Customer paid 20000"

Result:

Payment recorded.

Upload receipt image.

Result:

Expense automatically created.

"What is my profit?"

Result:

Financial summary returned.

21. USSD Platform

Example:

*555#

Menu:

1 Sales 2 Expenses 3 Inventory 4 Loans 5 Balance 6 Credit Score

Purpose:

Support feature phones and poor internet environments.

22. SMS Backup System

Examples:

SALE 25000

EXPENSE 5000

BALANCE

LOAN

All commands processed via SMS.

23. Low-Bandwidth Architecture Principles

Requirements:

Offline first

Store locally.

Sync later.

Lightweight assets

Compress:

- Images
 - PDFs
 - Documents
-

Progressive loading

Load:

- Text first
 - Media second
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WhatsApp-first workflows

Reduce app dependency.

USSD fallback

Support all devices.

24. Regulatory Compliance

Nigeria-specific requirements:

- NIN
 - BVN
 - KYC
 - AML
 - CBN regulations
 - NDPR compliance
 - Consent management
 - Audit trails
 - Fraud detection
 - Transaction monitoring
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25. Revenue Model

Subscription

Free

Starter

Business

Enterprise

Lending commissions

Bank referral fees.

Payment processing

Transaction fees.

Insurance

Business insurance commissions.

Financial services marketplace

Partner commissions.

26. Key Metrics

Acquisition

- Businesses registered
 - CAC completed
 - Activated businesses
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Engagement

- Monthly active businesses
 - Transactions
 - Receipt uploads
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Financial

- GMV

- Revenue
 - Loan volume
 - Repayment rate
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Lending

- Default rate
 - Approval rate
 - Average trust score
-

27. Technical Principles

Must support:

- Mobile first
 - Offline first
 - Low bandwidth
 - API first
 - Event driven
 - Highly scalable
 - Regulatory compliant
-

28. Product Roadmap

PHASE 1

Marketplace MVP

Timeline: 3–4 months

Deliverables:

- Authentication
- Business registration
- Storefronts
- Product catalog
- Services catalog
- Sales recording
- Inventory
- Invoice generation

- Receipt generation
- WhatsApp sharing
- Dashboard

Success metric:

1,000 businesses onboarded.

PHASE 2

Business Operating System

Timeline: 2–3 months

Deliverables:

- Expense tracking
- Supplier management
- Purchase orders
- Receipt OCR
- Analytics dashboard
- Profit analysis
- Cash flow tracking

Success metric:

500 active businesses.

PHASE 3

Banking Integration

Timeline: 3–4 months

Deliverables:

- Bank integrations
- Transaction feeds
- Reconciliation
- Overdraft monitoring
- Spending analysis

Success metric:

100 connected businesses.

PHASE 4

AI Layer

Timeline: 2–3 months

Deliverables:

- AI bookkeeping
- AI assistant
- Financial insights
- Business recommendations
- Forecasting

Success metric:

70% bookkeeping automation.

PHASE 5

Trust Score Engine

Timeline: 2 months

Deliverables:

- Trust score algorithm
- Business scoring
- Risk engine
- Lending recommendations

Success metric:

Accurate scoring model.

PHASE 6

Lending Marketplace

Timeline: 4 months

Deliverables:

- Loan marketplace
- Partner banks
- Loan workflows
- Repayment engine
- Collections

Success metric:

First 1,000 loans issued.

PHASE 7

Low Connectivity Expansion

Timeline: 3 months

Deliverables:

- WhatsApp bot
- USSD platform
- SMS platform
- Offline sync engine

Success metric:

50% usage outside app.

29. Long-Term Vision

CODA becomes:

- Shopify for African SMEs
- QuickBooks for African SMEs

- Stripe for African SMEs
- Experian for African SMEs
- Credit bureau for African SMEs
- Banking operating system for African SMEs

Ultimately becoming the trusted financial identity layer for African business.